

Why Can't America have High-Speed Bullet Trains? – Metallicman

 metallicman.com/laoban4site/why-cant-america-have-high-speed-bullet-trains

congjing yu

May 24, 2019



Well, California Governor Gavin Newsom has abandoned plans to build a high-speed railroad between Los Angeles and San Francisco. After spending billions of dollars in funds, much of it from the Federal government, the Governor said that the project should be shelved.

He cited that the project was [too expensive](#).



The face of American politics today. This is the slick and well-packaged oligarchy pick for California. Mr. California Governor Gavin Newsom. Look how plastic he appears. Why, he could be right out of one of those political villains from a 1980's John Cusack movie.

- [California Is Abandoning A Plan To Build A High-Speed Rail](#)
- [California Scraps Plan For LA-San Francisco High Speed](#)

- [Gov. Newsom Says No 'Path' for High-Speed Train](#)
- [CA Gov. Gavin Newsom Scales Back High-Speed Rail](#)

Managerial elites, Of Two Minds - The sole output of America's managerial elite is self-serving hubris. The Deep State can't be fired, nor does it ever stand for election.

As systems become more complex, the need for a professional class to manage the overwhelming complexity grows.

"Stakeholders" multiply in endless profusion, dooming every project to a glacial process that increases the sums paid to manage the glacial process and pushes the final cost to the moon.

The managerial elite always has one answer for every problem: give us more money.

The system is broken, and the managerial elite will keep it broken because it serves their interests to keep it broken.

Some History

It all began ten years ago. Back then, President Obama [called](#) for a network of high-speed railroads to criss-cross the country "within 25 years". The nation roared with glee and cheering his forward thinking.

Perspicacious = To be far-sighted in understanding things.

At that time, of course, the rest of the world had already implemented High Speed Rail. America was going to get involved in a game of "catch up".

Only this time, progressive values and liberal management would lead the way.



Look back. The year is 2009; "President Obama's goal of building a high-speed rail network that at least 80 percent of Americans will have access to by 2025, is facing major resistance in Congress. Earlier this week, Vice President Joe Biden announced a \$53 billion, six year plan to get the U.S. high-speed rail network going with \$8 billion over the next year spent towards building new lines and upgrading existing passenger lines in areas such as the northeast and midwest.:

His [plan](#), began its' implementation through California.

Of course, compared to the rest of the world, it's pretty modest. The idea was to link the two largest cities in California together. This would occur by placing rail lines through the large entirely rural California valley. The top speed would be limited to 220 MPH, which is the global norm. The most ambitious plans would have 800 miles of rail line, paid in part by the Federal government and bonds issued by the (insolvent) California government.

Killing the High Speed rail program.

The decision to cancel this program was welcomed by Conservatives, and derailed by Liberals. Both for reasons related towards political considerations. However, in my mind, *everyone* loses.

What's worse, rubbing salt in the wound, comes President Trump. He rightfully questioned the decision to kill the project. As a businessman, you do not casually start of kill things without study, and an analysis of the consequences. Obviously, there were concerns that the decision to kill the project were not carefully thought out.

Seriously. It is like going to a restaurant and expecting to pay \$100 for the meal. You wait and you wait, and you wait. Finally, the waitress comes to the table. The bill is \$2000.

You get angry!

Where is my food? Why has it taken so long? What the heck are the cooks doing? What do I have to show for all my time; for all my

money? What?

And the waitress looks at you condescendingly, and points to the toothpick that is on that table.

"You have a toothpick", she says.

Thus, in summary, and rightfully so, President Trump demanded that California be fiscally responsible and return the Federal funds given to them.

- [Trump demands CA return billions in high-speed rail money](#)
- [Trump demands California return high-speed rail funds](#)
- [Trump administration demands California return billions](#)

California fights back and builds the High Speed rail... somewhat.

These were funds earmarked for the doomed program. However, the Governor rebuked him. He argued that no funds needed to be returned. He said the state would still build a portion of the system. It would build the section still under construction in the rural Central Valley.

You demand to see the Manager, or better yet, the owner of the restaurant. A few minutes, he comes out of his office. You interrupted him from playing the game of poker he had with the other workers.

We wipes the beer off of his beard and takes a puff of his cigar.

"Wadda ya want, bub?"

You calmly, and clearly, state that you paid for a meal. And that you want the meal, and you want it at the price that is advertised on the menu.

He snorts!

"Sure, wadda ever ya say. That will be another \$4000."

You get angry, and suddenly all the workers in the restaurant come out and line up with the Manager. They start yelling at you. Calling you names like "deplorable", "uneducated hicks", and "racist". They carry on so much, that you eventually slither out of the restaurant.

You cut your losses. You reason, at least you got a toothpick.

So, California is going to build the high-speed rail after all.

By doing so, he could legally claim that he met the requirements that California build a High Speed rail line. It wouldn't need to be very much rail. Not even a few hundred miles or so of rail. Five, ten or fifteen miles would be all that would be needed.

Everyone files back into the back room, and continues their game of poker. Another case of beer is brought in. No one notices the line of people at the front door waiting to be served and led to their tables.

His advisors suggested something a little more practical, though. So a little over a hundred miles will (some day... eventually) be built.



A plywood, and paint mock up of the American High-speed rail engine. It only cost a few million to make such a fancy plywood "doll house" for kids to play in. take note that the progressive plan for the design, and manufacture for the locomotives would be from the German multi-national company Siemens. No American design. No American factories. No American construction. This would be a fully funded international, and globalist initiative. So very progressive!

Everybody gets their cut...

Once the labor unions get their cuts, the environmentalists get their shares, the local labor bosses get to skim off some money, and the politicians in Sacramento each get another new mansion, can the tiny amount of rail line be built.

[California High-Speed Rail Project Whistleblower Comes Forward](#)

Look here! So wonderful!



California High Speed Rail as envisioned by the Democratic Governor. The cost of many billions of dollars will be used to provide a non-vehicular transportation method for those commuters between Merced and Bakersfield.

This couple of miles of track would be enough to prove that the rail was built in "good faith". (And not a scheme to siphon Federal funds into the pocket of various special interest groups.)

So, there! You evil non-progressive, you!

Progressive justification for the “new” High Speed rail.

Of course, the need for a High Speed rail to travel a distance that a [person could drive in a little over an hour](#) is rather silly. However, the Governor denied that it would be a “train to nowhere.”

He justified his plans stating that many people would want to abandon their cars for public transportation [between Merced and Bakersfield](#). (Then use public transport, such as taxis and public buses, to get around in those cities.)

Of course, it is debatable whether he actually believes this statement personally. Were it to function he, and his family would never use it. They are members of the elite. They travel by private jet. They don’t travel by “cattle car” like the rest of us.

Though the administration bills the program as “high-speed rail,” most U.S. projects won’t reach the speeds seen in Europe and Asia.

[-Obama doles out money for High Speed Rail](#)

He defended his decision on reasons of fiscal responsibility. (Of course he would. It “sounds good”, like the words “fresh”, “green”, and “healthy” does.)



The usefulness of the California 77 billion dollar high speed rail program. Map shows the major population areas of California for reference, and to show that the rail does not impact any of these areas. The reader should note that 77 billion far, far dwarfs the amount of money that NASA spent to send men to the Moon. To me, by looking at the map, they put this rail line in the absolutely middle of frigging nowhere. How in the world is it supposed to help anyone out there?

California needed the money for it's many social programs. It needed the money to support the influx of illegal migrants, and it needed the money to support the rising number of unemployed poor. California needed the money for yet another study on the endangered bo-bo-tiutsi fly, and the impact on plastic straws have on “global warming”.

Important things. Don't ya know.



Memes erupted all over America when the various progressive liberal governments announced banning of plastic straws. Here's one such meme.

He would not give any of money back.

Not that he could mind you. Too many people accepted bribes. Too many studies" on the dangers of coffee and the need for LGBT education in Kindergarten needed to be funded. Where the heck do you all think all those crazy radical progressives get their money to live off of? Do you actually believe that they work in a company like a normal person would?

After spending over 77 Billion dollars, he said the state would not send any money back to the federal government. He did not want it to be spent by President Donald Trump.

China started planning and implementing High Speed rail back in the 1990's. Today, High Speed rail transport in China is ubiquitous. It is "old news". Eventually, in China, all rail will be replaced with High Speed Transport.

Construction has been underway for the last couple of years on a section of 220 miles of rail. This section consists of the system from Silicon Valley to the Central Valley, with expected passenger service in 2025. (Now, delayed until 2035.) The announcement to kill the plan has resulted in a much smaller stretch of rail being realized.

The fares were expected to average \$89 per person per trip.

Which is about 2x (two times more expensive) than Chinese High-Speed rail, cover a mere tiny percentage of a fraction of the distance that Chinese rail covers, and start roughly 35 years later than when China built their first High Speed rail line.

Not that it matters. Just sayin'

All of this is silly.

In reality, this is not a technical issue, or even a fiscal issue. It is a political issue. It is a mechanism from which politicians, beholden to donors will be able to pay them back for the money that they lent to the progressive liberal democrats.



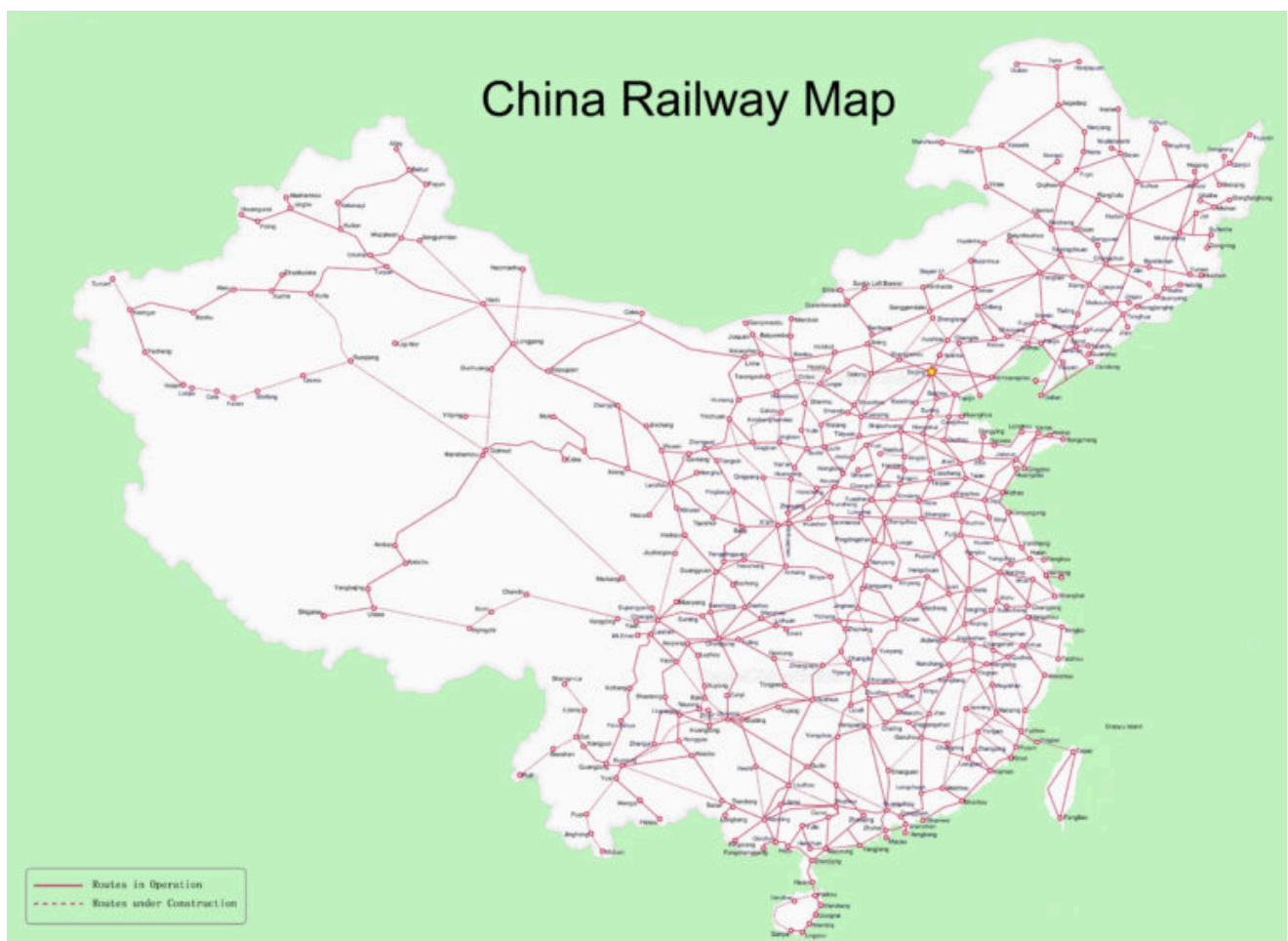
Interior of an Amtrak bathroom. American rail is not maintained, or treated with the care that is required for rail transport. This is evident to anyone who rides on Amtrak.

It is so very obvious, and so blatant, I will not insult the reader by showing pages and pages of justification. If you can't see the reality, then, maybe you need to go back to school and learn some discernment skills. You know, like elementary school.

77 Billion Dollars and NOTHING to show for it!

The corruption in the USA, and California is so very bad, that 77 Billion dollars and 20 years can not complete a single spur line of high speed rail! Well, China started at the same time as California did.

Look where China is today...



Chinese High Speed rail as of 2019. All of these lines are in the process of conversion to High-Speed access, and old-style rail will be obsolete and phased out over time. Look what you can do without legalized bribery, and absolute corruption.

Chinese High Speed Rail

Now, China just so happened to decide to implement High Speed rail at the same time that California did. The result is quite different. Why?



Alexandre LEVY 알렉스 亚历山大 列维 • 2nd

International Business Partner

5h ...

It's fascinating to see how extended this high-speed-rail network has gone on to become... Put it in perspective, it is possible to board a CRH train in HK and half a day later arrive in Beijing... and on a personal note, having experienced CRH first-hand, the comfort level and stability of the train (who cares how much foreign tech has been embedded or not), is quite telling of where China's headed.. First class*****

👍 · 3 Likes | 💬 · 5 Replies

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Thorbjørn Olsen - 雷神 • 2nd

CEO @ Nordic Trolls (VR)

3h ...

Agreed. I don't even consider taking a plane anymore when doing Beijing - Shanghai - Beijing. Taking the high-speed train always get me to my destination at lower total travel time, and it's way cheaper as well + I get to look at my whatever screen whenever I like ;) Kudos to China for long-term thinking and an incredible ability to follow through with their plans in an efficient way.

Chinese High Speed Trains are the absolute best.

Well, let's do some comparisons shall we.

First off, let me be clear that NOT every line is high-speed rail. This is a work in process. Secondly, it is also clear that China is an enormous nation and right now the High Speed rail only connects major population centers.

Today, these are the **active** High-speed rail lines...



Active 2019 high-speed rail map in China listing all the station names. This is the map that you can use today to plan a high-speed travel anywhere in China. Click on the image to see a full-scale, enlarged view.

Here is a typical Chinese bullet train. (I just cannot show you any United States bullet trains because they haven't even been constructed yet. Though there are some nice colorful mock-ups. See above.)



Adel "Al" Mabrouk, P.E.

Strategic Planning/ Infrastructure+Facilities/Engineering+Operations /Pro...

4h ...

Some just don't want to give credit where credit is due.The high speed network in China is the best. The expansion of the network over time has been well thought out . Enjoy the ride my friend.

 · 2 Likes

 · 6 Replies

Chinese High Speed Trains are the absolute best.

Oh, and I must add that the cardboard, wood and fiberglass (hollow) mock up of the California high speed rail COST MORE than an actual high-speed locomotive by many millions of dollars. Consider that will ya!



0:00 / 0:14



Inside a Chinese bullet train

Bullet trains are all over China. There is an enormous network of them. They are very comfortable to ride in, and their cost is reasonable. Notice how calm the ride is. Note the water in the bottle.

0:00 / 0:10

And...

Video Player

0:00 / 0:15

00:00

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America's Plan for a Progressive Future

Under Obama, and other progressive leadership in the seaboard corridors, they had (and still have) a very progressive vision for America. In their vision, the states would be discarded in favor of a new America of "regions".

- States would become obsolete, and over time, discarded.
- Administration regions would replace independent states.
- High Speed Rail would connect the administrative centers.

Control would be centralized in the mega-cities on both the East and the West. Thus, High-Speed trains would cart people through the barren "waste lands" between the "two important" regions of the United States.

As shown in this map from the New York Times...

The New York Times

A New Map for America



Rethinking the Map

How the lower 48 could be realigned into seven mega-regions.

Sources: Joel Kotkin (boundaries and names of 7 mega-regions); Forbes Magazine; Regional Plan Association; Census Bureau; United States High Speed Rail Association; Clare Traylor/University of Wisconsin-Madison Cartography Laboratory.

The High Speed rail is just a part of the new progressive vision the left has for America. It's no secret, though it isn't publicized to the masses. With the election of DJT, everything was put on hold until the Left can retake the reigns of power and continue on their march towards socialism.

Ah, but the corruption prevents the ideal.

That looks so nice, but it's never gonna happen. It implies that enough money will be available to manage and manufacture the progressive utopia.

As soon as Obama came to office he started throwing money at this. And, like high-absorbancy disposable dish towels, the money evaporated.

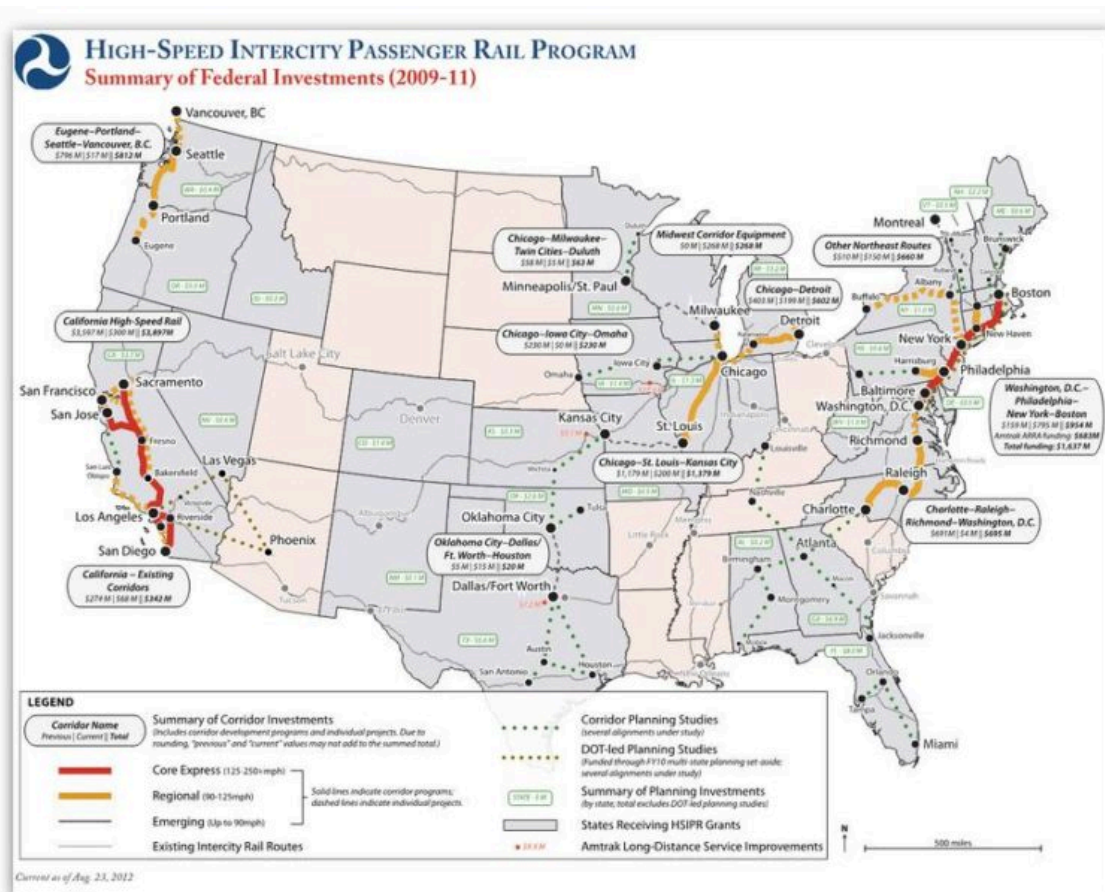
- [Obama Doles Out High-Speed Rail Grants](#)
- [Obama Unveils High-Speed Railway Plan](#)

PRESIDENT-ELECT BARACK OBAMA'S TAX PLAN:



Obama was very liberal with the tax monies, as well as the money not yet collected. He gave it away like party favors at a drunk frat party.

Just check out the amazing amount of corruption. Check out this map from the US government. Where did the money go? Eh?



Obama threw billions of dollars towards High Speed rail transport system, and his cronies all took the money for their own purposes. You know, like a new swimming pool for their third mansion, and redecoration of their Lear Jet. Ah, well that is life in America today. It's not pretty, but that is just the way that it is.

Comparisons of High Speed Rail

I looked at various sites on the internet, and it's a hoot how everyone tries to justify the superiority of Amtrak compared to China's bullet trains. They imply that China's bullet trains are nothing to be proud of.

It's funny, but sad too. You know, the first step in recognizing you have a problem is to face up to it, and announce that you have a problem. (12 step program for those of you who don't know the reference.)



Crime and corruption in the USA is institutionalized and regulated in legal means. Thus it is not officially considered a crime. Pretty slick, eh?

They do one on one comparisons and come to the conclusion that they are *similar*. What a laugh. The trains are similar. How can you possibly come to that conclusion?

The one article (linked above) starts off straight forward enough...



Price isn't the only difference. [gui jun peng/Shutterstock, Amtrak](#)

But then it starts to show a bunch of photos how they are really just pretty similar, aside from the price, and speed. As if the train stations are identical. (Have you been to an Amtrak train station lately? Talk about a run-down 1960's era ghetto.)

Really?

Here's a screen capture from the article listed above.

American Amtrak service attendants wear collared shirts and scarves.



In the comparison they say that the two systems are pretty much the same. After all, it is the politically correct thing to say. Right?

What's what the article says.

Then, it shows this following picture...

China's bullet train service attendants add a hat.



Is that the only difference? Really? Are you so dumb founded blind in political correctness not to notice the differences right in front of your face?

Is that the only difference? A hat?

Really? Are you so dumb founded blind in political correctness not to notice the differences right in front of your face?

In China, the stewardesses are all female. They are all attractive, and rated in beauty, physical appearance, and weight. They are all under 35 years of age. They are trained to be demure and act very respectfully.



Chinese hostesses. They are judged not only on their ability, and their scores on tests, but in their appearance. That is why when you go to China all of the hostesses are very attractive and giving and providing the best to you, the customer.



Hostess rejected because her fingernails were not good enough. In China everything must be perfect and done to the best of one's ability. There just isn't any acceptance of inferior job performance due to any of the criteria that plagues Western society.

In America on Amtrak, there are no age, appearance, weight or gender requirements. The attendants can be polite or not, fat or not, ugly or not, burly or not. In the progressive reality that is America today that is the reality. But don't deny what is right in front of your eyes just for the sake of political correctness.



American rail; Amtrak stewardess. I have nothing against older people working, whether they are male or female or confused-gender. However, it must be recognized that the Chinese put more emphasis on appearance and ability than what is present in the United States.

Chinese High Speed Train Appearances

This is what the interior of one looks like...

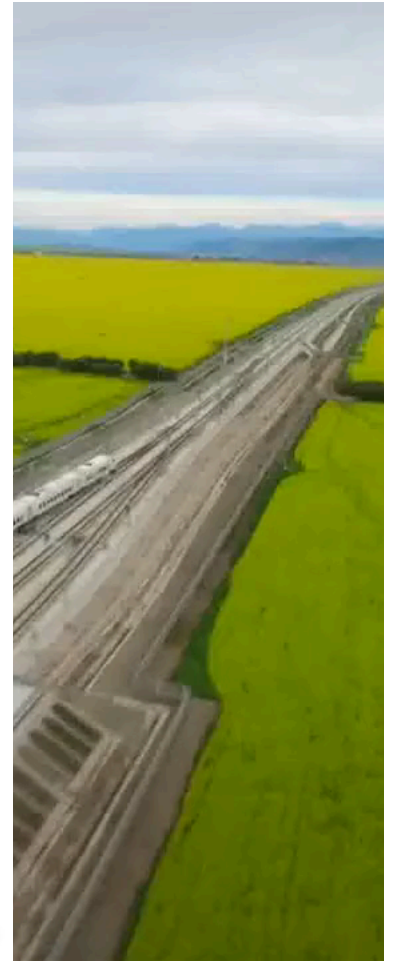
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And here's the view outside...

0:00 / 0:14

Oh, and while I am at it, here is what the over all appearance and image that the Chinese bullet trains have in China and around the world.

0:00 / 0:41



In contrast Amtrak is viewed as sluggish, antiquated, and brutish. Check out the video and then go ride on Amtrak to see what I am talking about.

Train Stations

Here's a quick comparison in train stations.

First, we check out Amtrak's stations. The photo below is a historical station known as Sandpoint. Now, don't get the wrong idea.

I do happen to love history and American rail has had so many *absolutely awesome* train stations. What about the one on Allegheny avenue in Pittsburgh, or the massive complex in Detroit? Ah, but they are all gone now.

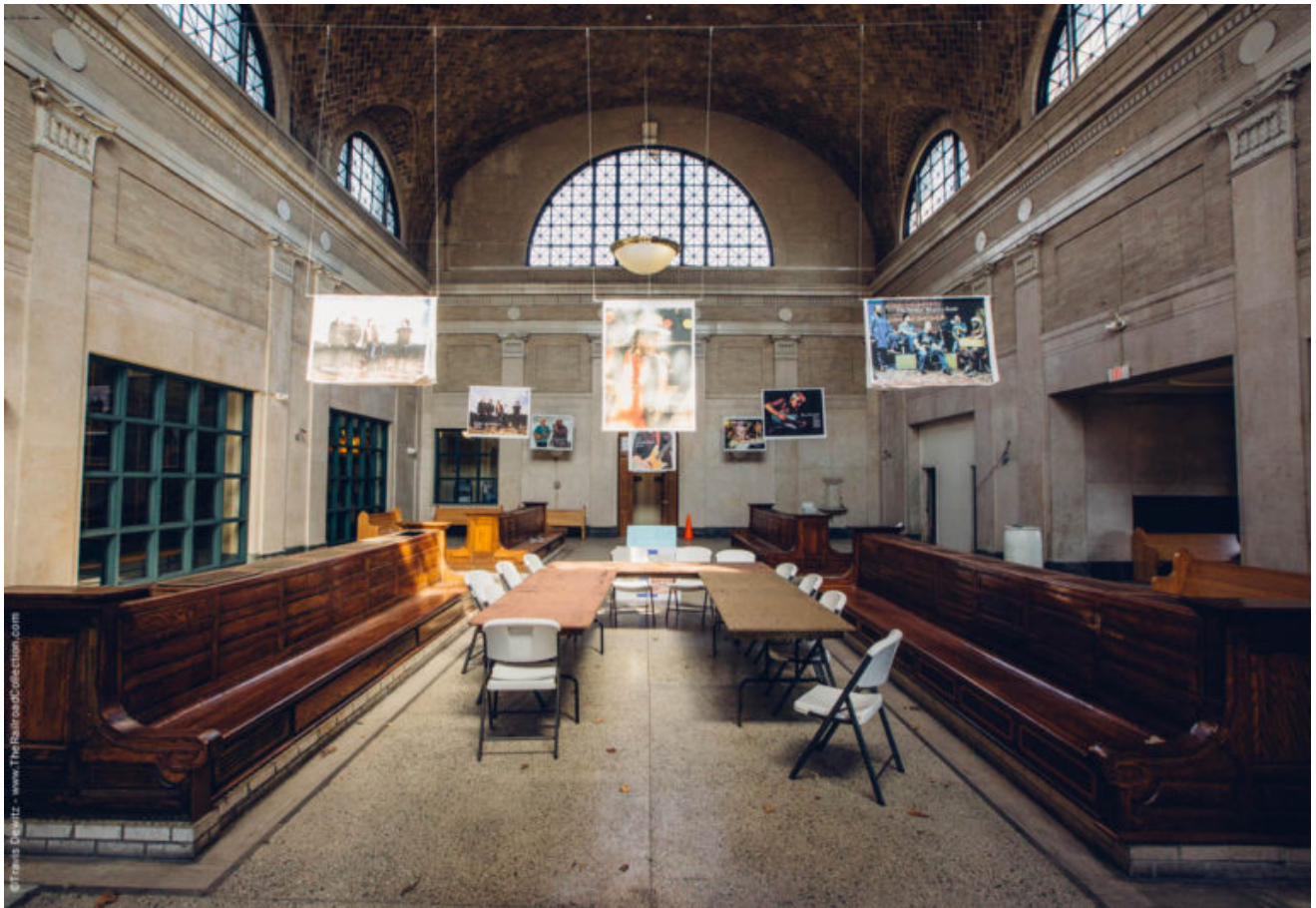


American train station – Sandpoint station. This is typical of what remains in the United States for railroad stations for passengers.

All that remains are little quonset hut kind of affairs. You know the kind used to give the impression of progressive advancement by tearing down the old. Sad.

Here's the current interior of the Amtrak rail station in Jamestown, Pennsylvania. It looks like the rest of the world has passed it by. It's really, really sad.

And, I don't like it one bit.



Interior of the Amtrak station in Jamestown, Pennsylvania. It's sad really. So much history, so much that can be done to keep and preserve it.

Now, let's look at the train stations that you would encounter were you to board a train in China. This is from the 3rd tier city Tianjin. It's third tier, ya all! It's just a little Po-dunk city.



Chinese train station in Tianjin, China. It is new. Well taken cared for, and well maintained. There are no beggars and the floors are so clean that you could eat off them.



Chinese high-speed rail. Look at all those bullet trains. How many billions and billions of dollars was spent for the California high-speed rail, and what? Only 15 miles were completed, and not one single train was fabricated? What a waste. America is much better than that.

Ask yourself how, and why can China do this, but much bigger, and better USA cannot? Maybe fighting eight simultaneous wars and spending 65% of welfare benefits on illegal aliens has something to do with it. Eh?

Maybe. But I also like to think that part of it is because China is a meritocracy.

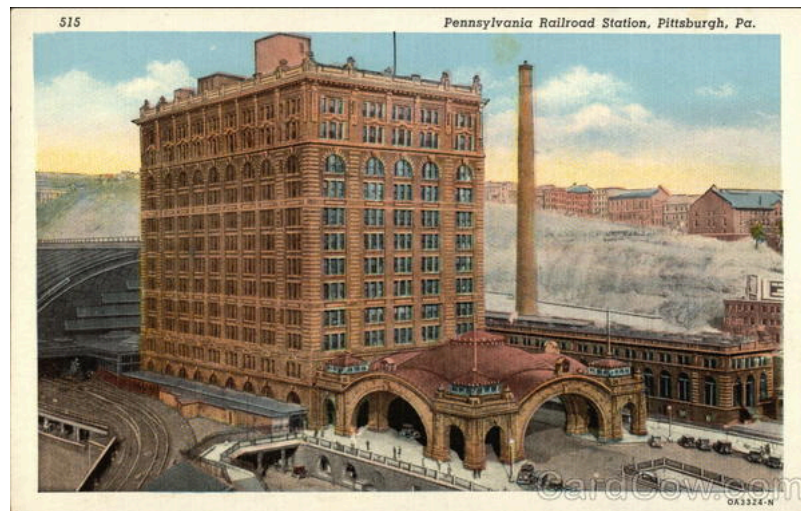
Here is Amtrak rail. This is what passes for American High Speed rail today. You know, as someone who can compare different ways of doing things, it is just so obvious the crime, decadence and corruption at Amtrak is just horrible.

For all the money being thrown at Amtrak, this is the best America can do? Really?



Modern Amtrak in the North East region. This is what American high-speed looks like.

America has so much to be proud of, yet we have let our achievements grow fallow, and our leadership become corrupt. We, our parents, and our grandparents are all responsible for the sad, sad state of affairs in America today.



Pennsylvania Railroad Station Pittsburgh

Chinese Stewardess Training

In China, it is very important to maintain a very positive image. This is reflective of the company, the brand and the service that one provides. Thus, there is a very rigorous selection process to become a stewardess on a Chinese train, and a long and involved training program.

Here is a video showing how the stewardess are trained to walk.

0:00 / 0:13

And, here are how they are trained to act and greet people...

0:00 / 0:15



Of course, the criteria in the United States is quite different.

The American rail system is controlled by Amtrak and it is a government funded agency. As such, it is very progressive, and very “modern” and “diverse”. You won’t find attractive women, or training on how to behave at Amtrak. Instead you will find other criteria that is “more important” being used.

Some other criteria...



Amtrak is a very "forward thinking", progressive liberal government agency. Everything is top-down controlled by the Washington DC central office, and all the management got into their positions of power through liberal progressive leanings and "other means" (not to be discussed here). You can easily see how wonderful this has been when you compare Amtrak with train and rail lines in the rest of the world. Yessur!

These other criteria are things that you cannot speak about, but everyone knows about.

You know, like how certain famous people got their children into Harvard and Yale, or like how some cute starlets got their start in Hollywood by visiting a couch.

It is like how you have to show some cleavage to get the Pennsylvania department of transportation to fill the pot-hole in front of your house, or how the Mexican dishwasher gets paid for washing pots and pans. That is how things are *really* done in America today. If you haven't experienced this, then you haven't really experienced the America that the "rest of us" has to endure.

Eh? Maybe you have a silver spoon in your mouth. Or a Starbucks coffee. It's the same thing really.

Reality. You know, like the child molester teacher that lives down the street, or the potholes in the road that never get fixed, or the "extra" "fees" that you have to pay the gal behind the window to get some attention to your issue.

Ah, all so very progressive.

Just like things used to be done in the Soviet Union under Stalin, or how things were done in China under Mr. Mao. So equal. So diverse. So progressive.

"The toilets in your car are not working anymore. Please, use the ones of the car in front of you. Do not enter the sleeper cars. I repeat..."

The day has barely started when we hear the announcement. I am exhausted after a sleepless night on a half-reclined chair."

[-Roaming about on Amtrak](#)



Amtrak workers showing their uniforms and attire. Notice how progressive and diverse they are. That's fine for a nice liberal progressive reality. However, I personally like the way rail used to be run in the United States...by merit, not by the color of one's skin. Which is one of the reasons why Chinese high speed rail is light years more effective than anything in the United States.

Just how far did America go down the drain?

It's hard to vocalize. I like to think that the best years of Amtrak were in the 1930's. It was a time that I did not experience. All that I could picture were the faded images of massive locomotives, and advertisements of luxury travel inside old Life and National Geographic magazines.

City of New Orleans by Arlo Guthrie

I'm pretty saddened by it, actually.

1:30pm: We are stopped and the power disappears with a *buzzzzzz*.

No AC, no lights, no nothing.

Soon, it becomes quite hot. The electricity has had hiccups before (ask Mark who has to re-set our router each time), but never this long. Apparently, one of our engines has a problem.

The power returns, the passengers sigh; the train is still motionless.

[-Roaming about on Amtrak](#)



Boarding trains in the United States tends to be like this, crowded and rushed. There just isn't the kind of order that is demanded in Chinese train stations.

7:25pm: The train stops in Cleburne, TX to offload the passengers going to Oklahoma who take a bus from here, because they missed their connection in Fort Worth.

We sit at this station for half an hour and don't know why. This is becoming infuriating! No information, just a grumbling crowd.

The way Amtrak "solves" problems is the epitome of inefficiency. On all accounts.

[-Roaming about on Amtrak](#)



RailPictures Net - Image Copyright Ryan Schmelzer

America high-speed rail today. Here is a picture of contemporaneous American rail.

Like most passengers on the Texas Eagle that day (and, believe it or not, but all the trains we took were fully booked), we are tempted to say "Never Again"!

Long-distance train journeys have a certain appeal. Each one is an adventure. The ones on Amtrak even more so, it appears.

What we have learned first-hand is that all the rumors about Amtrak are true. The company is ran very inefficiently and nobody seems to care about multiple-hour delays, reroutings or change of itineraries/schedules except for the passengers.

It was an experience, but we are not jumping to do it again. Beware: anyone traveling on Amtrak's long distance trains should have lots of time, and no connections!

[-Roaming about on Amtrak](#)

Let me tell you Liesbet that train looks absolutely first class compared to our train and trip overnight from New York to New Orleans.

What a nightmare trip!!

Let me guess why the trains are so bad going down south. Disgusting!! The train was on freight lines so was very bumpy and very uncomfortable.

We did book first class, the guy laughed when we asked where that was. Yes, we were stood out like a sore thumb on the train!!

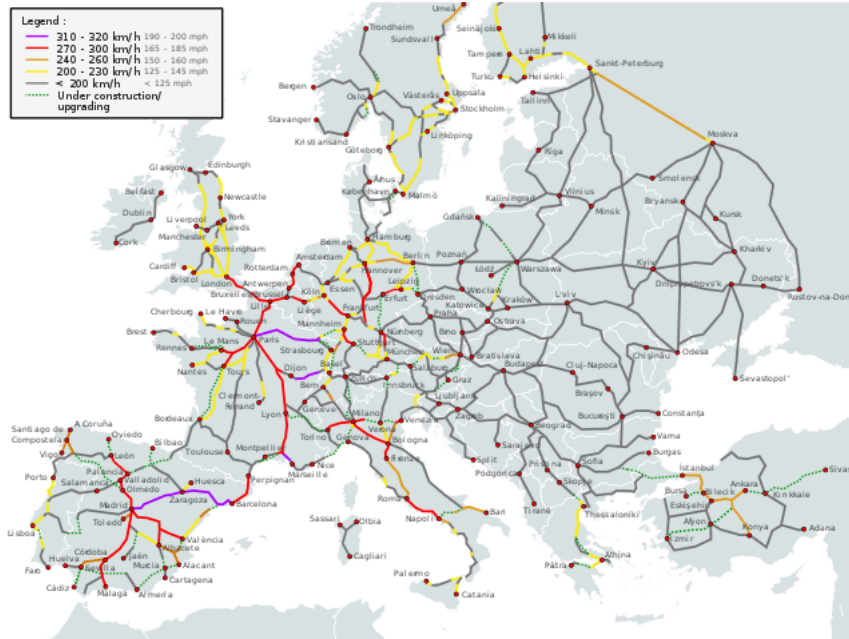
- [globalhousesitterX2](#)

High Speed Rail elsewhere

The rest of the world uses High Speed rail. It's a mature technology, and provides benefit to the people who live in the nations that have it.

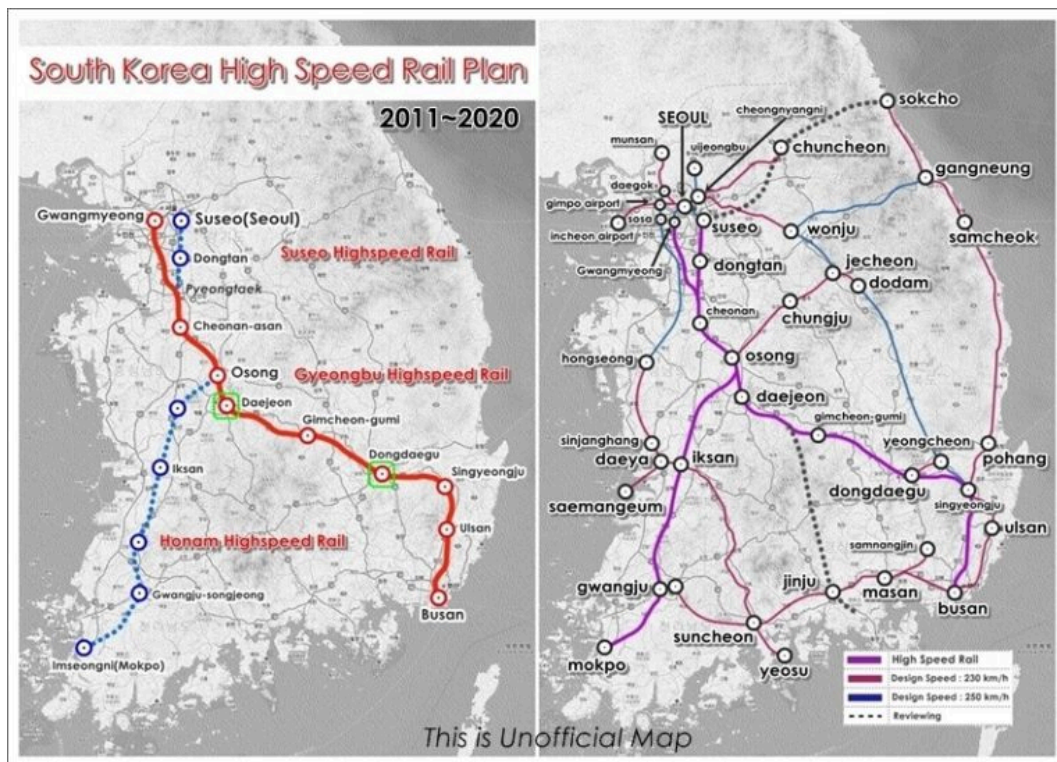
Everyone has it. *Except* the United States.

Don't believe me, well then take a look at these maps here. Here's Europe.



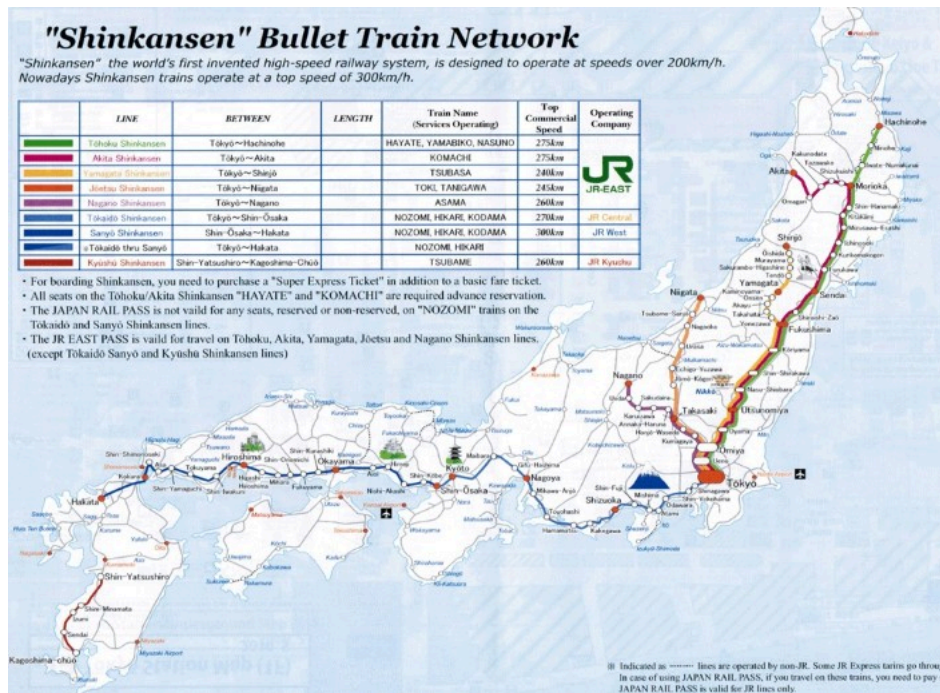
European High Speed Rail.

And how about tiny South Korea...



South Korean High Speed Rail.

Japanese High Speed Rail...



Japanese high speed rail network.

And, here's Australia's High Speed rail network (in construction)...



Australian high speed rail.

Here is the high speed rail in Brazil. It connects the largest cities for low cost, and fast transport for it's citizens.

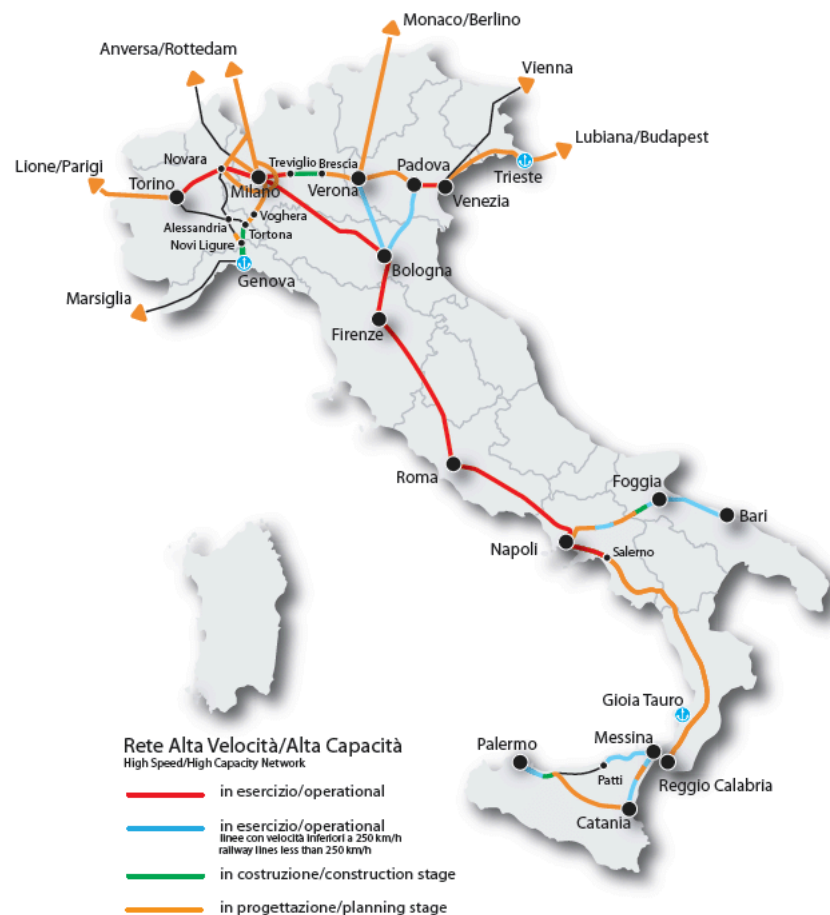
DE CAMPINAS AO RIO

Trajeto planejado para o trem-bala contempla seis cidades



Brazil high speed rail map. Showing the rail corridor that connects the largest cities together.

Here's the high speed rail network for Italy...



Italian high speed rail map.

Even tiny Java has high speed rail. What is America's malfunction? Eh?



High speed rail in Java, Indonesia.

Russia is in a class by itself

Russia has had rail for as long as the United States. However, they have worked out various agreements with the Chinese, and are now upgrading their trans-Siberian route to be High Speed Rail. And what an upgrade it is.

I mean, well I really admire Chinese High Speed rail, but OMG the Russians have taken it to the [next step](#)! And you can find out about their “budget” travel [HERE](#).

Here's a map of what it looks like.

Map of Trans-Siberian Railways

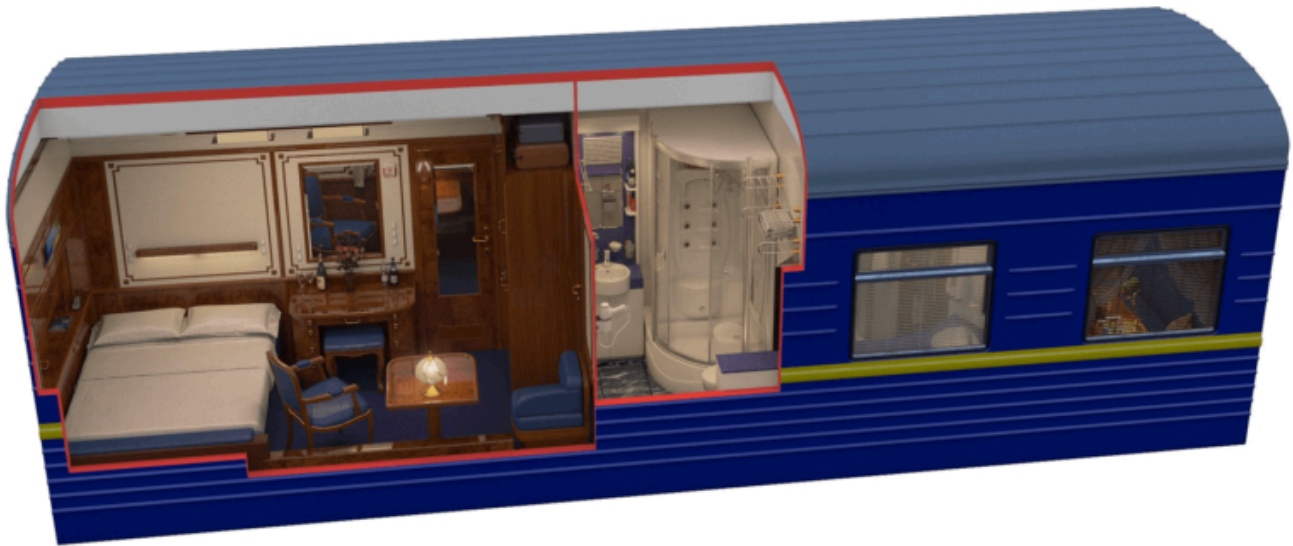


Source: Guide to Russia.com

Russia & Chinese High Speed Rail map. The Russians have collaborated with the Chinese to improve existing rail lines and upgrade them to High Speed Rail.

And here are some cross sections of the various cars. I particularly like the first class cabins. Maybe I can pretend to be James Bond and travel West with a Femme Fatale. Eh?

A femme fatale is a stock character of a mysterious and seductive woman whose charms ensnare her lovers, often leading them into compromising, dangerous, and deadly situations. She is an archetype of literature and art. -Wikipedia



Golden Eagle Imperial class stateroom for first class passengers on the Russian trans-Siberian rail that is being upgraded by the Chinese to High Speed rail.



This is the staterooms for the Golden Eagle "Gold" class for the trans-Siberian High Speed rail.

The Golden Eagle is your luxurious hotel-on-wheels. Unpack just the once and settle into your well-appointed and comfortable en-suite cabin as you begin this voyage of a lifetime. One of your cabin attendants, available at all times, will be on hand to look after all of your needs.

The Golden Eagle, comprising three categories of cabins, featuring state-of-the-art amenities, and all offering en-suite facilities, is the only private train of its kind operating in this part of the world.

Our newly introduced Imperial Suites are the most spacious cabins on the Golden Eagle, and on any train in Russia. The Gold and Silver Class accommodation has been cleverly designed to maximise the available space as cabins convert from a sitting area by day into a comfortable sleeping accommodation by night.

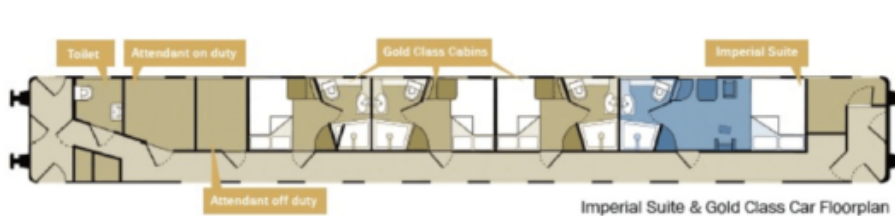
On the occasions where we travel by day, your cabins provides a calm, personal space in which to read, enjoy a DVD or simply watch the landscape unfold through the large picture window and the facility to adjust the air-conditioning for your own personal comfort.

All three classes of cabin benefit from an evening turndown service and the services of a cabin attendant who is on call 24 hours a day. Our onboard cabin attendants are highly regarded by our guests for their impeccable service. In each cabin you will also find an excellent selection of L'Occitane shower gels and shampoos, complemented by premium bath robes, slippers and a hairdryer.

[-The Trans-Siberian Travel Company](#)



There are three classes that you can have when you travel by rail. Golden Eagle Imperial Class. Golden Eagle Gold Class. Golden Eagle Silver Class. There is also a Shangri La Diamond Class, and the Shangri La Heritage Class



Trans-Siberian high speed rail car layout.

Causes and Commentary

America is out of pace with the rest of the world in regards to high-speed, modern mass transit. America relies on personal automobiles, the airlines, and an antiquated railroad system that is corrupt and bureaucratic.

There are many reasons why America is unable to have high speed rail. The primary ones are **politics**, and **corruption** associated with politics.

In America, criminal enterprise that siphons enormous taxpayer funds into various "programs" has been institutionalized and made legal. These moneys are no longer available to American taxpayers for programs that support their life, their community, or their future.

They are siphoned away for "other" purposes.



"The U.S. has now spent more on reconstructing Afghanistan than was spent on the Marshall Plan and the reconstruction of Europe."

— Matt Wuerker on Tuesday, August 4th, 2015 in a political cartoon on Politico



How about spending some of this money on American bridges, American public transportation, American education, American needs, and American rail? How about it eh? Or, are there too many wealthy people siphoning the money away?

An Intolerable Situation.



Vintage American rail. Art Deco design, with traditional order and behavior. It was a glad and welcome time; a time when men could work for a living and still keep almost all of his money without being bothered by the tax man.

Personally, I find this situation intolerable, as I have a personal love and affinity for AMERICAN rail. As a boy, I used to walk the railroad tracks that wound in and out of the hills of Western Pennsylvania. I used to explore the tunnels and old rail side communities. I used to stand in awe to those enormous engines that hauled the coal from the depths of the earth.



This is what American rail used to be. It was large, powerful and proud. Not the wimpy bureaucratic corruption filled organization that it is today.

My first train ride was to university and I traveled the "red eye" from Erie, PA to Syracuse NY. I fell in love with rail from that moment on.

I loved everything about it.

I loved the stewards in the dining car with their white starched uniforms, to the big burly train conductor and his cheery announcements. I loved watching the countryside go by, and having a 5am breakfast of coffee and toast in the dining car.

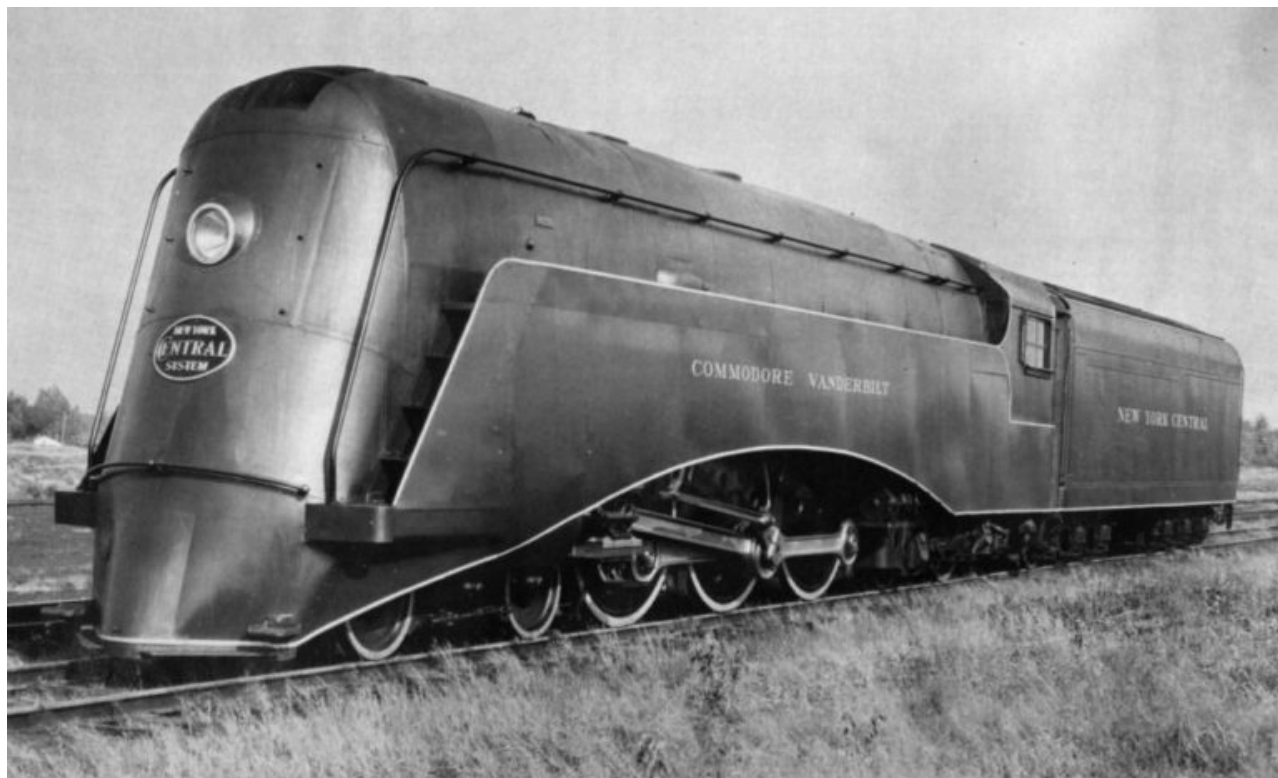


In traditional conservative America, people were proud of America and it's accomplishments. One of which was the rail lines. This is the America from my boyhood. What happened?

I lament this loss, and this post is my anger that corrupt people have taken something so wonderful, so fantastic, and turned it in to what it is today. Today it is nothing more than a failed business model staffed with the bland and the politically acceptable.



It is my hope; my prayer that other lovers of AMERICAN rail will wake up and wrest the rail industry from the corrupt politicians back to the people where it belongs.



The America that used to be, or is it really over? What can we do to regain America to take back it's glory days?

Article was posted on FR 26MAY19

This article was posted (well, the first three or so paragraphs, anyways) on the conservative website Free Republic on 26MAY19. The post is [HERE](#), and some selected comments (from people who obviously didn't read the article).

Here's some of the best comments.

I used to work for this company that had a contract with a large corporation and I used to have to go in to the large Corporate Offices occasionally and I would go in early to grab a little breakfast in their cafeteria. That's what I noticed that everybody who was on the "early work schedule" would get there early and then leisurely eat a breakfast and be up with their desks just before the normal 8 to 5 people showed up. Pretty sneaky, because the early workers left early... but didn't put in a full day...that's when I learned that having an early staff is probably inviting a little cheating into the workplace.

As a Ferroequinologist (railroad fan), I'm going to say, we can but let private companies do it. Virgin Trains is expanding Brightline from West Palm to Orlando...and onto Tampa...

Conclusion

So, to answer the question; "Why can't America have High Speed Rail transportation?", if you set aside all the rationalizations and justifications, there is but one conclusive answer.

In some ways, extreme populism actually is a symptom of this institutional failure, and this brings me to my last point. Due to our lack of a functioning institutional system, we are no longer able to undertake great, long-term projects, or to address seriously deep structural problems in our system in the long term.

We suffer from a kind of "tyranny of myopia." We are incapable of operating as a country on anything resembling a serious and long-term time horizon.

[-American Greatness](#)

America does not have the ABILITY to create modern public transportation.

I have not been to Niagara Falls in close to 30 years even though I live 80 miles from there. I have driven by it many times over the years but it was one of those things that since I had been there repeatedly as a kid, I saw no need to go there again.

Well, my kids are now 10 & 12 years and it was time to take them to see it.

The city of Niagara Falls is a total dump. It might as well be Detroit, Newark NJ, The level of devastation is identical. It might as well be the third world.

Then, there is the New York State Park around the American Falls. Like every park in New York state, it is a complete embarrassment. This park should be a showplace, and yet it is a total shithole. I was stunned at the complete lack of maintenance the shoddy landscaping and the overall poor condition of the park as a whole. Obviously, the state has the money to squander on illegal aliens but the parks are a complete mess and an embarrassment.

The Canadian side park was well kept and was an attractive and enjoyable place to be. The city of Niagara Falls, Ontario as a whole is not the welfare basketcase that Niagara Falls NY is.

Andrew Cuomo, Louise Slaughter (now dead), and every other NY democrat ('Nadless I'm looking at you) should be ashamed of themselves for turning this place into a disgrace.

[-Vanity Post](#)

Some Updates

[\\$14B Texas High-Speed Rail Contract Goes to Salini Impregilo-Lane JV](#)

A joint venture of Milan-based contractor Salini Impregilo and its U.S. subsidiary Lane Construction Corp. have won a \$14-billion design-build contract for the planned high-speed rail project to connect Dallas and Houston, with a total estimated cost of some \$20 billion.

Salini-Lane will provide civil and infrastructure scope for the project, which includes design and construction of all 131 viaduct sections and 130 embankment sections along the 240-mile route, installation of the track system, and construction of all buildings and services that will house maintenance and other equipment.

Not going to be made by Americans or American companies, though. Also the scope is going to be rather modest. 240 miles for \$20 billion dollars.



The Popular Music of China

This is a very long post, divided into 16 parts. It discusses popular Chinese music in all its' forms, from rap to disco, to Country & Western to foreign influences. It's pretty comprehensive and ends up going all over the place. But it's perhaps the best introduction on the Internet outside of Classical Chinese music.



Some fun micro-videos of Chinese weapons and their use

This is a post about various Chinese weapons systems, with a few side journeys related into politics. We talk about piracy and corporate layoffs as well. We discuss piracy in the South China Sea, politics and the reporting of Naval Operations. We talk about corporate layoffs and how all this is connected.



The Chinese Love of Off-Road Vehicle Adventures

The Chinese love the automobile culture, and all of it's various sub-cultures. Here we talk about their love for camping, adventure and travel in huge caravans in the Chinese Western deserts. We look at full-dressers, RV's, dirt biking, Mud Slinging, and other popular Chinese pastimes.



The Tale of the End-of-the-Day Potato

When you finish a good day's work, how do you like to be rewarded? How about a nice beer, and a nice well-cooked meal? How about your dogs or cats near by? How about a kiss on the cheek, a nice frosty alcoholic beverage in your hand? Or, as I have found, my end-of-the-day potato.



News as Every-Day Dog-Shit

Has the news that you read every day benefitted you? Has it made your life better, happier, calmer or helped you to make more money? What benefit do you derive from reading it? Chances are that it provides no benefit at all; you are just a slave to habit for others to manipulate.



Attack of the Dancing Grandmothers

One of the things about China is that the old folk love to dance and exercise. They get up at the crack of dawn and dance to loud disco until every goes out to work. Then they rest. They return to dance at dinner time until night. Here is my take on this crazy and popular Chinese pastime.



The Dance Craze that is Sweeping China

China is a big country, and as such it has passing fads and events that everyone seems to participate in. The latest is a dance craze that is based on a silly song involving Tarzan like yodeling. Everyone is doing it from kids, to policemen, doctors and entire school classrooms.



When the SJW Movement Took Over China

Many people are unaware that the SJW movement is not regional to the United States. It is global. It reoccurs in a generational cycle. China has experienced three such cycles in my lifetime. This is the sad story of what happened when the SJW's were permitted to run amok in China.



The Importance of a Family Meal Together

One of the most important things that I have learned is that friends, family and close-ones should share meals together. Further, they should do so with some sense of formality and purpose. Here is my take on this issue, and how I prefer to structure my family meals.



Freedom and Liberty in China

As Americans we have been raised into believing that America is an oasis of freedom in a world of chaos. We have been taught that other nations are shit-holes and that communist nations are the worst. Well, the 1960's narrative doesn't play well in the 2020's reality.



The Ben Ming Nian – The 12 Year Curse

The Chinese believe that all life have both a physical reality and a non-physical reality. As such it goes through a twelve year cycle. Every twelve years it sort of resets itself. A new phase of life thus begins. Here we discuss this from the point of view of interactive quanta and patterns.



Beware the Expat

There are a handful of expats that have left America to explore a new life outside of America. We do so for many reasons. Some of us want a new quiet life, while others want excitement. Still others want to unleash their criminal skills on an unsuspecting public. Be aware.



How to tell if Wine is Fake in China

There are many fake things made in China. From fake designer purses, to fake mouse-traps. If someone can make some extra money by making something fake, they will try it. Here, we talk about one of the most dangerous of fake goods; fake red wine.



How China Deals with Obesity

In the modern world, obesity is a real problem. People all over the world are getting fatter and heavier. The American solution is to ban fattening things, and make laws to control behavior. Here we discuss the Chinese solution; to provide areas to dance and exercise.



How a Business KTV Works in China

KTV's are all over China. They range from tiny booths, to family affairs to fancy palaces for friends. Here we discuss a kind of "seeder" side of the KTV phenomenon. We discuss the KTV used to discuss business and to reward high-performing employees; The Business KTV.



Great Wedding Ideas from Chinese Weddings

The Chinese have over 5000 years of experience in formalized weddings, culture, food and relationships. Here we spend some time looking at the contemporaneous Chinese wedding. We look at the fun and playful side of it for ideas that we can use in American weddings. Enjoy.



The story about how I got married to my Chinese wife.

The Asian culture, and especially the Chinese culture, is rooted in tradition. This tradition is very conservative. As such, the parents have a great deal in the determination of who marries whom and how. This is my story about how I was exposed to this when I had to confront the enormous hurdles to get married to my Chinese bride.



How Christmas is Celebrated in Communist China

Contrary to what most Americans believe, Christmas is celebrated all over the world. The progressive narrative of banning it, or turning it into a pale shadow of what it once was is a lie propagated by "diversity officers". Here we talk about the celebration of Christmas in China.



What Chinese Apartment Houses are Like

After a thirty-year-long growth spurt, China has forged an enormous and growing middle class. This has, in turn, created a need for consumer appliances, automobiles, and apartments. Here we look at what Chinese apartment houses are like. They are quite different.



Snapshots of Chinese Culture

China is a land that changes every few months or so. The roads change, the buildings change. The society, culture and traditions seemingly move with the changes in all sorts of interesting ways. Here we talk about these changes in the form of micro-videos. It's a fun post, most certainly.



What Rural China is Like

Unless you have lived in China, your impressions of what China is will have been colored by the news media. There would be mention of the new ultra-modern cities, and some discussion on the pollution in the industrial areas. No mention of anything else. Here we attempt to cover this omission.



Chinese New Year – cultural snapshots of society

The Chinese New Year (CNY) is a very important holiday in China. It has many cultural aspects regarding it that are unknown in the West. These things includes such things as spontaneous dancing upon arrival, quaffing hard grain alcohol and monkey parades. Here, present some videos of these events.

China and America Comparisons



Democrat Busybodies and the Destruction of Freedom

Wouldn't life be wonderful if you could just be left alone and live your life in peace? I think so. The founders of the United States thought so, however there is an army of busybodies who disagree. They have this vision of utopia where everyone listens to their commands.



Comparison between American and Chinese Playgrounds

The differences between American and Chinese playgrounds couldn't be more telling. It is a tale of how things are handled differently and the roles that parents take. In China the role of the parent is to equip the child for life. While in America it is to protect the child from life.



What Authentic Chinese Food is Like

The entire world feasts on “Chinese Food” served in “Chinese Restaurants”. This could be a Chinese take-out in Memphis, to a “Dim Sum” restaurant in NYC. As delicious as these establishments are, what is it like to eat real, Chinese food, in China? Well we talk about it right here.



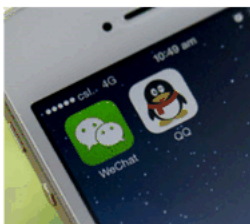
The Last Straw – Why I Left America

We all come to cross-roads in our lives. We experience life in all of it's glory and pain. This is the story why I left the USA and moved to China. It's not that I hate the USA, I love it dearly and miss it terribly. However, a series of events and changes pushed me out. This is my story.



What it was like for me to leave America for China.

This is my story on the final moments of my life in the USA. I had just completed my retirement sequence for MAJestic and I was released to enter the monitoring section of my retirement. I decided to get the tattered remains of my life together and move to China and this is what it was like for me to do so.



What happens when you try to implement Diversity Initiatives in China

This is a very good story in what happens when a young millennial tries to implement diversity initiatives in China. There are many lessons here. From how pompous SJW's are to misconceptions about what China is.



What High School taught me about Democracy

Yes, I know, the United states is supposed to be a Republic. However, running for president in school was set up as a Democracy with majority vote. I learned a lot about the follies of a Democracy and what eventually befalls it. I wish to share those experiences with you.



Why an American man should leave America and Travel

America is great. It is large and wonderful. However, we all need to set outside of it to really appreciate what we have, and to face what we do not have. Only then can we really understand where our problems originate from and how to resolve them



Top Ten Misconceptions that Americans have about China

There are many misconceptions about far-away places. China, due to its size, and relative importance as a source of manufactured products is often the target of many a ill-defined comment. The disconnect between reality and perception is enormous. Here we discuss it.



The Top Ten Misconceptions Chinese have about the USA

When the Chinese come and visit the United States, they are often spellbound in shock and amazement. They find that they LOVE, absolutely L-O-V-E the United States. I have many friends who have told me this. Another thing that they have told me is that it was not what they expected.



Comparisons Between American and Chinese Girls

Here we compare the differences in beauty between Chinese and American women. Since beauty is in the eye of the beholder, we spend some time looking at what makes women attractive to the opposite sex and why. Then we look at attractive girls comparatively.

The Chinese Business KTV Experience

This is the real deal. Forget about all that nonsense that you find in the British tabloids and an occasional write up in the American liberal press. This is the reality. Read or not.



How a Chinese Business KTV Works – Introduction

Here is the first part of a 17 post detailed explanation of how business is conducted in China, and more specifically, how a Business KTV operates. We discuss many things from the cultural context, to society, to relationships, to industry and the rewards awarded to high performers to propaganda.



How a Chinese Business KTV Works – The Tea Ritual

No matter if you go to a KTV, or just are visiting friends, you will be presented with the “Tea Ritual”. There are numerous tea rituals, and here in this instance, we discuss the events of drinking tea prior to meeting company bosses and using tea to wash out cups and dishes for dinner.



How a Chinese Business KTV Works – The Dinner

Fundamental to conducting any social or business activity in China is the formal dinner. This is substantially different from anything in the West, and is often misunderstood. In China offering some food is more than just being polite and hospitable, it is a way of gaining *guangxi*. We talk about this here.



How a Chinese Business KTV Works – Respect and Food

To conduct business in China, you do need to have some idea of what is going on and why. China has centuries of culture and traditions. These have been established for many years and works towards defined purposes. Here we talk about some of the various aspects of why things work this way.



How a Chinese Business KTV Works – Pre-party Preparation

Here we talk about leaving the dinner celebration and getting ready to go to the KTV to have some fun. We discuss what is involved, the various issues that take place and how things works. This is more or less an intimate look at some of the various aspects of a Chinese business KTV.



How a Chinese Business KTV Works – The Pretty Girls

One of the things that appeal to me about the Chinese business KTV is the ability to get to sing and dance (!) with intelligent, attractive and beautiful Chinese ladies. Here, we look at the girls and what they are like. The American narrative of flat-chested, pre adolescent appearing brown-skinned waifs is way, off-track.



How a Chinese Business KTV Works – Selecting a Companion

On of the great things about KTV's (and bars and clubs for that matter) is that you don't have to be alone. You can rent a companion to sing with. You can rent a companion to play games with you, to dance with you and to play jokes with. It's a great way to have fun, and we discuss this aspect of it.



How a Chinese Business KTV works – About the Girls

Here, we talk about the hostesses that work in the Chinese Business KTV's. They differ from girls that might work in the bars, the clubs or in other venues. It's an interesting subject, because I happen to like girls. Especially ones that can sing, dance and drink wine, and harder beverages with me.



How a Chinese Business KTV Works – Having Fun!

Here we discuss the various fun (!) aspects of a Chinese business KTV. We talk about the pretty girls, the playful games. We talk about the singing, the dancing, the drinking... Oh, and the smoking. We talk about the importance of it and why it is important for adults to have a release valve from life.



How a Chinese Business KTV works – NSFW Parties

Let's talk about adult entertainment. In the West, especially in America, all adult entertainment is restricted or banned. What is permitted is done in secret and in shame. It need not be that way. Here we discuss some ways that consulting adults have fun. I personally think that it is great.



How a Chinese Business KTV Works – Singing, Dancing and Money

Now we talk about the various aspects of a Chinese business KTV in much more detail. We talk about the costs that a Chinese boss would have to invest in this kind of activity. We talk about why this kind of event is important and how it inspires workers...



How a Chinese Business KTV Works – Pretty Boys for the Girls

Of course, China might be traditional, but it is not sexist. For reasons of political expediency, In America tradition is associated with sexism. That is not the case, and China exemplifies that. In China you can have both female and male companions. Here we talk about the Hosts that are available to the well-heeled boss.



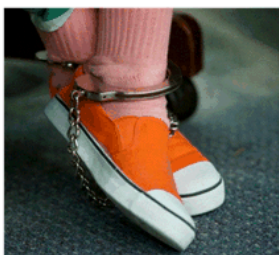
How a Chinese Business KTV Works – Going to the Hotel Room

All good things must end, but when you are dealing with the Chinese business KTV, the actual KTV event is only a part of the entire ritual. In fact, the real excitement comes later (provided you are worth it, proven yourself, and valuable). The real fun comes when you can relax and rest in your hotel room.



How a Chinese Business KTV Works – The Next Day

Your eyes open up slowly. You find that you are nude and there are girls in the bathroom taking a shower. Your clothes are nicely folded off to the side, and there is purple vomit in the sink. You can't find your glasses, or your cell phone. You go and pee and are led back into bed. Here we talk about this...



How a Chinese Business KTV Works – Crackdowns & Propaganda

The Western media is full of stories of sex exploitation in China. These stories are salacious and juicy. They speak of kidnapped child slaves that are used to service rich wealthy men. They speak of the poor girls that must service man after man, over and over, a living nightmare. It makes great copy, but is totally false.



How a Chinese Business KTV Works – Opinions of the Ignorant

Due to the enormous (profitable) media campaigns, there are many ignorant and incorrect ideas and opinions regarding China. This covers everything from those poor abused Muslims to milking rats. Here we talk about this. We spend time looking at how a traditional Chinese society is bemoaned by the progressive West.



How a Chinese Business KTV Works – What the Girls are Like

There are so many misconceptions about what the Chinese people are like. Here is my attempt to clear up some of these misconceptions and take the time to describe what modern, contemporaneous Chinese women are like, what motivates them, and why there are fun to be with.



How a Chinese Business KTV Works – The Ideal Girl

When you have 600 companions to select from, how do you choose? How can you find the “right” girl when every girl is a 9.7 or better? It’s a tough decision, I know, but it need not be impossible. Here are some guidelines that I use when selection a companion to play with.



How a Chinese Business KTV Works – Younger Girl

In a KTV, most of the girls are between 23 and 30 years old. However, sometimes you might come across a younger girl. These girls can be as young as 21. They are not as “good” or experienced as the more talented, established KTV hostesses. Here, we look at them and their unique qualities.



How a Chinese Business KTV Works – Conclusion and Summary

There are so many aspects to a Chinese Business KTV that it is common to reject everything due to our innate prejudices. Personally, I think the Chinese people are terribly misunderstood. I think that they are doing things RIGHT, and it is us in the West that need to take a good hard look at our life.

Learning About China



Learning About China through Looking at Pretty Girls -1

Here we discuss elevators, eating at work, subways, residential areas, apartment building hallways, riding on boats, family KTV’s, getting out of cars, tennis courts, department stores and restrooms. It’s pretty amazing what you can learn by looking at pretty girls.



Learning About China through Looking at Pretty Girls -2

Here we discuss suburbs and memorials. We discuss malls, Arabic culture, parking garages, bedrooms, living rooms, and living in Guangzhou. We discuss walking and talking. Finally a nice hypnotic dancing video for fun. It's pretty amazing what you can learn by looking at pretty girls.



Learning About China through Looking at Pretty Girls -3

Here we discuss more malls, farms and their kitchens, pools, apartment (3rd floor) parks and open areas, dance studios, military barracks, riding on a yacht, beaches, waterslides, and the garages outside a housing development. It's fun talking about China with all sorts of pretty girls.



Learning About China through Looking at Pretty Girls -4

Here we discuss public parks, gyms, work offices, apartments in Shanghai and the excellent views there, the Southern Chinese coast, Pizza Hut, speaking and singing in English (as a second language), sofas, safety at night, the ideal face, and buying gold in Hong Kong.



Learning About China through Looking at Pretty Girls -5

Here we discuss Shanghai, highways, hotels, exercise, and elementary school students dance-exercising, after-school dance classes, public squares and dancing and carrying on in public. We talk about rural kitchens, doors in apartments, and Chinese apartments in general.

Contemporaneous Chinese Music

This is a series of posts that discuss contemporaneous popular music in China. It is a wide ranging and broad spectrum of travel, and at that, all that I am able to provide is the flimsiest of overviews. However, this series of posts should serve as a great starting place for investigation and enjoyment.



The Popular Music of China – Part 1

We start the discussion of contemporaneous Chinese popular music by one of the top songs of the year. It is Bulgarian translation of a Rumanian rap-song. We discuss how it ended up in China and why it is popular. We also discuss the Chinese love for Kenny G and music rotation in China.



The Popular Music of China – Part 2

We continue with the influences of other Asian nations such as Vietnam and Thailand on the Chinese popular music scene. We make comparisons to popular United States music and notice the differences from the basis of society and cultures. We also continue looking at Polish and Russian musical influences.



The Popular Music of China – Part 3

We introduce some great web pages for exploration of Chinese popular music on your own. We also have some nice micro-videos featuring the “news weather girl”, LOL. We talk about remixes, and DJ activity. We also look at Americans who have found a niche in China by singing in Chinese.



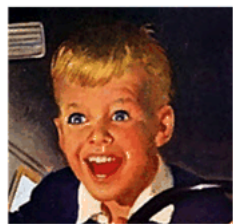
The Popular Music of China – Part 3B

We talk about the Chinese love of bars, clubs, and KTV's and we also talk about beer; yes. Glorious, glorious beer. We discuss how beer makes everything sound better, and taste better. We talk about music and steaks. Music and hot dogs. Music and hamburgers and holy fires, and yes music and beer.



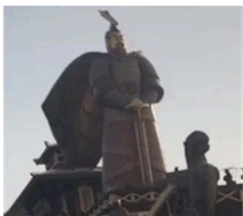
The Popular Music of China – Part 4

We talk about the Chinese love American music and how it manifests. We look at why many of the American songs that the Chinese listen to are not familiar to the vast bulk of Americans who visit China and why this is the case. We continue our study of enjoyment, singing, dancing and of course, beer.



The Popular Music of China – Part 5

Here we look at how the music is enjoyed in China, and we compare it to how the music is enjoyed in the United States. Truthfully people in both nations love to sing, it's just that Americans prefer to sing in the privacy of their car and their shower, while the Chinese do not have any qualms about it.



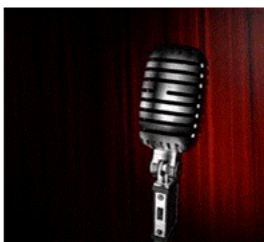
The Popular Music of China – Part 5B

Here we view the music of China through the lens of the Chinese transformation away from a pure-Communist nation to a conservative- traditionalist authoritative nation. And, we look at how that has shaped the musical tastes and preferences of the citizens in comparison to the American Progressive society.



The Popular Music of China – Part 5C

Here we compare the conservative-traditional social aspects of China with that of the Progressive-liberal aspects of America. We look at the music of the preferred medium and we watch micro-videos that clearly illustrate this schism between the two cultures and societies.



The Popular Music of China – Part 5D

China is what it is today because of the events of the past. The last few hundred centuries or so has not been very easy, and those Chinese that survived to exist in today's China are well aware of that fact. To understand China you must also understand its history and culture.



The Popular Music of China – Part 5E

China can be very interesting from the point of view of an American. This is especially true in regards to music. One of the biggest surprises to me was that there were Country & Western songs that my Chinese friends knew and could sing to. Couple that with Texas beer and hotdogs and you'll be a happy Joe.



The Popular Music of China – Part 5G

One of the great innovations that hit American culture around 1981 was MTV. This was the main-stream adaptation of music and video to create miniature movies. It could have gone into many directions, and did, though today MTV is more like a negro ghetto than what it is in China. China loves these MV's.



The Popular Music of China – Part 5F

We run through more micro-videos and embeds to explore the Chinese music scene. In this effort we are exposed to Chinese music videos, and Chinese songs. We see how they mirror popular culture and how the Chinese people use this music to enhance their lives.



The Popular Music of China – Part 6

What do men aspire for? Do they want to be metro-sexuals like Barack Obama, or raunchy playboys like Justin Bieber? What do women aspire towards? Do they want to be career oriented and live a childless life running a major international company? And how does their individual drives influence their musical tastes?



The Popular Music of China – Part 7

Life is meant to be lived. And thus music is a way of expressing our feelings, hopes, dreams and desires. Here we discuss how the music is used in Chinese soap operas, and how it is used to express the frustrations of life. We talk about the passions that people have and how music is used as a vehicle for them.



The Popular Music of China – Part 8

Here we look at how China influences all of Asia. For China is one of the more populous nations in Asia and its influence spills over the Chinese border into other nations. We see how fads and trends in China influence the pop scene, and look at the Chinese love of K-pop, C-pop, and T-pop.



The Popular Music of China – Part 9

Here we look at role-play and the Chinese love of their history and their traditions. We look at how this love is mixed with contemporaneous popular music, and how and perhaps why, you can see this juxtaposition readily in China, as well as why it differs from America's hate of cultural misappropriation.



The Popular Music of China – Part 10

Here we discuss the costuming aspects of role-play and dress-up that seems to be a continuing popular pastime in China. The gals and the guys would wear historical costumes and gallivant all over the cities and countryside. We have examples and discuss this to some degree.

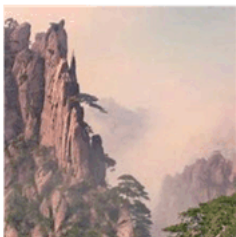


The Popular Music of China – Part 11

Here we conclude our study of contemporaneous Chinese music with some points of consideration. Points that I personally believe are lost on all Americans who have grown accustomed to the American way of doing things, and thus lock us out of full understandings of what reality is, and what China actually is.

Parks in China

The parks in China are very unique. They are enormous and tend to be very mountainous. Here we take a look at this most interesting of subjects.



What Visiting a Park in China is like (part 1)

This is a discussion on the great parks of China. We look at what it is like to visit them, and the way the park system is structured. We also take the time to investigate the general state of health that you need to visit the parks with. This is part one of a multi-part post.



What Visiting a Park in China is like (part 2)

Here we talk about the parks in China. We talk about wildlife, birds, narrow gauge trains, glass bridges, stone carvings and other things and attributes that are typical of China. We discuss what they are like to a Westerner. Most parks in China do not resemble anything that you can find in the West.



What Visiting a Park in China is like (part 3)

Parks in China are all about having fun with friends and families. This differs from the West where parks are areas set aside for natural growth and lovely vistas. In China, parks are participatory locations where people can live life. This means that many parks have rides, and other curious adventures.



What Visiting a Park in China is like (part 4)

Here we discuss outings with friends and rides at theme parks in China. The rides tend to be a tad more risky than what you would find in the West. The outings tend to be a little bit tamer than what you would find as well. It's a great contrast. It's all about fun and spending time with friends.



What Visiting a Park in China is like (part 4B)

Here we discuss high speed rail in China. These are known as "bullet trains" and are extremely fast. They have various types depending on their speed, and the fastest are absolutely amazing. We look at them from the point of view of going to a park in China.



What Visiting a Park in China is like (part 5)

Visiting a park can bring you closer to nature. It can often be a spiritual event. When you are with friends, and experience nature, you get the opportunity to see yourself and your life in a different light. We discuss this. As well as glass floored bridges, fine escapades and other amusements.



What Visiting a Park in China is like (part 6)

China is a land of amazing beauty and scenery. It is also a place where people are free to express themselves creatively and in other ways. They have this freedom of expression that is not hampered by social justice warriors or their ilk. We talk a little about this and how much fun it is to have freedom.



What Visiting a Park in China is like (part 7)

There are all kinds of people in this world. All kinds of people with all kinds of interests. Some like parks and others like cities. We all have one thing in common though. We all like to have friends. Here we talk about sharing park experiences with friends.



What Visiting a Park in China is like (part 8)

Here we conclude our series of posts on exploring the parks of China. We look at life and nature and why visiting parks are important. We take careful consideration as to our friendships and relationships, and look at why they are important and how they can be strengthened at Chinese parks.

Really Strange China

Here are some posts that discuss a number of things about China that might seem odd, or strange to Westerners. Some of the things are everyday events, while others are just representative of the differences in culture.



Really Strange China (Part 1)

Here we look at monkey style and other means of self defense. We look at China as an educational device so that we can learn about ourselves through comparison with others and other ways of doing things. We look at what happens when you drink too much and police dogs that know CPR.



Really Strange China (Part 2)

Here we look at regional festivals and events in both the United States, and (of course) China. As such we talk about apple butter, and hot fresh topping for sundaes. We look at some of the things that are truly unique about China and what it so marvelous. We also look at exercising at school and in gyms.



Really Strange China (Part 3)

Here we look at a singing chef in a Chinese restaurant. We consider beer, and the Chinese party scene. Would you be surprised if it is enormous? I wouldn't be. We also look at a poor guy that is having a bad day. Or maybe he just cannot drive. Or, maybe he is just too drunk. Poor guy.



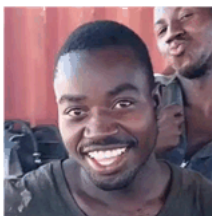
Really Strange China (Part 4)

Here we look at a disco swimming party, and summers in the United States during the 1960's and the 1970's. We look at what it is like attending college with other Chinese students and studying in the dorm rooms. We look at traditional fashion for the ladies and the Japanese invasion.



Really Strange China (Part 5)

Here we look at Chinese automobiles, and some really oddly shaped police vehicles. We look at the new technology that is being introduced in the Chinese domestic market. We look at bribery in the United States and Chinese drills regarding taking down Muslim terrorists.



Really Strange China (Part 6)

Let's look at the kinds of bonuses that you can get from your company when you work in China. We also watch a young inspired Michael Jackson (I like to think of her as Michelle Jackson). We also look at the Chinese involvement in Africa and their influence on the citizens there.



Really Strange China (Part 7)

Let's look at the "baby trials" which is a kind of ceremony that helps determine what vocation a baby boy will aspire towards. We also look at dogs and dogs riding in APP enabled bikes in China. We spend some time talking about how dog-friendly China is and how stores and establishments are regarding this.



Really Strange China (Part 8)

Here we talk about pets in China and why they are so different from pets in the rest of the world. We take a look at how noodles are made in China and the Chinese methods of crowd control. We look at rocket launches and community pools in condos and duplex communities.



Really Strange China (Part 9)

Here we talk about trick glass used on those people bridges in Chinese parks. We look at hidden closets, secret rooms, hidden staircases and secret passages. We look at Chinese voice activation in the latest Chinese automobiles on the market. As well as a small town restaurant and what it is like.



Really Strange China (Part 10)

Here we talk about the cool KTV environments, and how elaborate they are. We discuss robotic luggage and the start of their popularity in China. We look at night light shows, fireworks, lighted drones flying in formation and LED art on the sides of buildings.



Really Strange China (Part 11)

Here we talk about people helping others and coming to their aide and rescue. We look at underground China and all the underground malls and tunnels. You know, China is a nation that just loves to dig underground. They are constantly building subways and underground malls.



Really Strange China (Part 12)

Here we talk about a boys love for his mother, and giving her a bouquet of flowers. We discuss caring for the old, and feeble and grandparents. We look at the celebration of various festivals. We look at gold and it's usefulness if providing non-monetary work bonuses in China.



Really Strange China (Part 13)

Here we talk about Chinese bullet trains, and the enormous network that can take you all over China. We talk about train stations, and how the West minimizes the differences as being insignificant. We talk about bridges, testing of students and how you can use a Harley-Davidson motorcycle in China.



Really Strange China (Part 14)

Here we talk about Chinese malls and how impressive and big they tend to be. We look at young kids playing the drums in a presentation at a mall. We look at software programs to teach and entertain young Chinese students how to run a farm. We look at RV rentals, roads and population.

Articles & Links

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